Paid Arguments in Favor

Clear Accountability for City Government

San Francisco's Mayor is the city's chief executive but today directly appoints and removes only 6% of department heads. Responsibility is scattered across dozens of commissions and overlapping approval processes, making it nearly impossible for voters to know who is accountable when city government succeeds or fails.

This measure is drawn directly from SPUR's 2026 Charter for Change report and its 2024 Designed to Serve research — the product of SPUR's decades of nonpartisan work studying how San Francisco's city government actually functions, and how it can work better.

The measure gives the Mayor authority to appoint and remove most department heads, while preserving Board approval for the Controller, City Administrator, and Human Resources Director. It allows the Mayor to organize their office effectively, including using deputy mayors — a basic tool most big-city mayors already have. And it lets the Mayor propose reorganizing departments, subject to Board rejection within 60 days, so the government can adapt without a citywide election every time.

Critically, independent oversight is protected: the Ethics Commission, Elections Commission, Controller, City Administrator, Board of Appeals, Civil Service Commission, and elected officials like the City Attorney and District Attorney are all exempted.

When authority and accountability are aligned, voters can judge elected officials' performance at the ballot box. This measure ends the finger-pointing.

Vote YES.

Sean Elsbernd
President/CEO SPUR (www.spur.org)

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: SPUR.

GOOD GOVERNANCE LEADERS AGREE PROP F WILL IMPROVE ACCOUNTABILITY.

We've worked inside San Francisco's government, and we've seen the problem firsthand: departments that operate like independent fiefdoms instead of coordinated parts of one city government. When no one is clearly accountable, no one is truly responsible — and corruption grows in the gaps. Prop F fixes this broken system by letting the mayor hire and remove their own department heads, so corrupt or ineffective insiders answer to democratically elected leadership.

Importantly, Prop F doesn't concentrate power without checks. The Board of Supervisors can reject any reorganization proposed by the mayor. Independent watchdog commissions — Ethics, Elections, police oversight — stay exactly as independent as they are today. This is the kind of structural reform that good governance requires: clear lines of accountability, paired with real checks and balances. Vote Yes on Prop F for stronger accountability and better city services.

Former Controller Ben Rosenfield
Former Sheriff Vicki Hennessy
Former Director of SF Planning John Rahaim
Former Deputy City Attorney James Lazarus
Former Fire Chief Joanne Hayes-White

The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Clean Up City Hall, Mayor Lurie's Ballot Measure Committee.

The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. Michael Moritz, 2. John Pritzker, 3. Chris Larsen.

LABOR GROUPS SAY YES ON F FOR MORE ACCOUNTABILITY.

Working people show up and do the job every day — city government should be held to the same standard. Instead, San Francisco's departments too often fall short, yet never face real accountability. When departments fail without consequence, it's frontline workers and the public who pay the price through delayed projects, wasted public dollars, and services that don't work.

Prop F forces corrupt and ineffective department leadership to answer to democratically elected officials, not more city hall insiders. Accountable government means better-run departments, faster project delivery, and public dollars spent on real results instead of protecting insiders. Labor stands for accountability at every level: Vote Yes on Prop F for more responsible city government.

Firefighters 798
SF Building Trades
Teamsters Local 665
SEIU Local 87
*Carpenters Local 22 Senior Field Representative Dan Calamuci**
*Operating Engineers Local 3 District Representative Charles Lavery**
*Laborers Local 261 SF Liaison Anthony Travis Jr.**

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SMALL AND BIG BUSINESSES URGE BETTER RESULTS THROUGH PROP F.

San Francisco's businesses know the frustration of dealing with a city government where departments act in silos with confusing and conflicting rules instead of as one coordinated city government. The lack of coordination and accountability costs businesses time and money, as permits stall and project costs balloon.

Prop F creates clear reporting lines, so leadership is accountable to voters instead of hidden from them. Accountable city government means faster permits, better-run departments, and a city that works better for the businesses trying to build, hire, and grow here. San Francisco's business community supports real accountability: Vote Yes on Prop F.

Council of District Merchants Associations
SF Chamber of Commerce
Noe Valley Merchants and Professionals Association
Hotel Council

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CHINATOWN LEADERS URGE YES ON F TO END GOVERNMENT EXCUSES.

For too long, Chinatown and immigrant communities have dealt with a City Hall where government services fall short. Departments act in silos instead of coordinating and when something goes wrong, our community services suffer. Currently, the mayor cannot remove most department heads. That means the people responsible for delivering city services to Chinatown often face no consequences when they fail.

Prob F will ensure a more accountable city government with faster, better-run services for every neighborhood. Chinatown deserves a government that answers for its results without excuses. Vote Yes on Prop F for stronger accountability.

Chinatown History and Culture Association
*Eva Lee, SF Chinatown Merchants Association**

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The three largest contributors to the true source recipient committee: 1. Michael Moritz, 2. John Pritzker, 3. Chris Larsen.

Paid Arguments Against

Billionaires Buying "*Unitary Executive*" Mayor

When San Francisco voters rejected 2024's billionaire-backed "*Proposition D*" ballot measure, "*Proposition E*" created a "*Commission Streamlining Task Force*" Mayor Lurie and SPUR managed stacking with SPUR board members, including **Ed Harrington** and **Jean Fraser**. "*Prop. D's*" proposals included eliminating San Francisco's Health Commission!

The Task Force was hell bent on implementing Trump's "*unitary executive theory*." It colluded, implementing SPUR's agenda to hand exclusive, greatly expanded "*strong-mayor*" powers to Lurie (see www.stoplhhdownsize.com/Commission-Streamlining-Task-Force-Draft-2025-12-12-Meeting-Minutes-Sunshine.pdf).

The Task Force pressed further, despite San Franciscans' vigorous "**No Kings"** opposition, nationally or locally (see www.stoplhhdownsize.com/Streamlining-Task-Force-Proposes-King-Mayor-Power-Grab.pdf).

"**Prop. F**" would allow Lurie to reorganize executive branch departments — with 15 exceptions, plus **not** departments headed by elected officials. He could transfer powers and functions, consolidate one or more departments under a single department head, and assign transferred functions to different oversight commissions. Lurie ***could*** consolidate or eliminate the Police and Fire Departments; Mayor's Office of Housing and Community Development; **Rent Board**; Human Services Agency; Human Rights Commission; **Public Health**, Planning, Environment, and Disability and Aging Services departments; and others.

Like Trump, renaming the "*Defense Department*" to "*War Department*," and emasculating the CFPB?

"**Prop. F**" allows Lurie to hire four or more "**Deputy Mayors**" — averaging $250,000 salaries each, excluding fringe benefits — which voters banned 35 years ago, rejecting "**Prop. H**" in 1991. Lurie wants Mayoral staff raises, too.

"**Prop. F**" strips Commission's from developing three-nominee "*short lists*" to hire their respective Department Heads, and expands the Mayor's sole authority to hire and fire them without Board or Commission involvement.

It also would authorize appointing authorities — Lurie, District Supervisors — to remove their appointees to most boards and commissions ***without cause***, essentially "***at-will***" appointments.

Stop these billionaires: No "Unitary Executives." *No Kings*!

Vote "No" on Propositions "F" — and "A," "D," and "E," too!

Patrick Monette-Shaw
*Columnist, Westside Observer**

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The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Patrick Monette-Shaw.

Street Safety Advocates Say No on F! Don't Let Politics Block Lifesaving Progress

Since 2014, over 350 people have been killed in crashes on San Francisco's streets. A woman hit by a truck on Market Street on August 7 marked the seventeenth tragic death this year alone.

We can fix our streets and save lives. Through the SFMTA's Quick Build program, improvements like new lighting, new traffic signals, new crosswalks, and road diets have kept traffic flowing while making city streets safer.

Prop F threatens that progress.

Prop F politicizes the SFMTA Board, which must approve street projects. With Prop F, a mayor could remove a board member without cause — for any reason.

Special interests who oppose street safety improvements can and will exploit this. One phone call to the mayor's office could halt lifesaving fixes on our streets. Even a mayor who wants to promote safety will be under pressure to fold.

As neighborhood advocates, we know San Franciscans want safer streets. When done thoughtfully, street projects enjoy widespread support in our communities. But we've also seen unrepresentative opposition, from a connected few, block improvements most neighbors want. **Prop F makes this problem far worse.**

Voters have already rejected political meddling in our streets. Approved in a landslide, 1999's Prop E deliberately structured the SFMTA Board to be independent of City Hall bickering. Prop F reneges on that deal.

We cannot afford to go back to letting politics block lifesaving improvements on our streets. **Vote No on F.**

*Chris Arvin, Chair, SFMTA Citizens' Advisory Council**
*Austin Milford-Rosales, Member, SFCTA Community Advisory Committee**
*Jaime Viloria, Outreach Manager, San Francisco Transit Riders**
Aditya Bhumbla
Al Hawley
Jessica Jenkins
Maureen Persico
Scott Feeney

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The true source(s) of funds for the printing fee of this argument: Scott Feeney, Chris Arvin, Jessica Jenkins.

San Francisco Elections: Safe and Secure

To learn about how the Department of Elections ensures security and integrity of local elections, please visit sfelections.gov/security or contact us.



There are a number of things you can do to help protect the integrity of our elections! Here are some suggestions to help you get started:

- ☑ Check your voter registration record regularly to make sure all information, including your address, is correct and update it as necessary;
- ☑ Subscribe to our official news, updates, and notices at **sfelections.gov/trustedinfo**;
- ☑ Follow us on social media (**@SFElections**);
- ☑ Report misinformation, questionable claims, or suspicious activity, such as fraud, corruption, or tampering, to any of the following:
  - Our office: **(415) 558-6100** or **sfvote@sfgov.org**
  - San Francisco District Attorney: **(628) 652-4311**
  - California Secretary of State: **(800) 345-8683** or **VoteSure@sos.ca.gov**